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Search Committee
Department of Economics
Robins School of Business
University of Richmond
410 Westhampton Way
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Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track Assistant Professor position in the Department of Economics at the University of Richmond's Robins School of Business, beginning in the 2026–27 academic year. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

The Department of Economics at the Robins School of Business is consistently ranked among the very strongest liberal-arts-business school economics departments, with a stated focus on health economics, applied econometrics/computational economics, and student-centered learning. My interests in heterogeneous returns, portfolio dynamics, empirical macroeconomics, and computational modeling align directly with this focus. I am especially drawn to the School's commitment to experiential learning through its Spider Business Hub and its culture of preparing students for real-world careers with analytical rigor and ethical grounding.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level

macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students “convince themselves” that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Richmond I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows, evidence-based decision-making, and direct application to business and policy contexts.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to macroeconomic, business-economics, and policy-relevant questions, and (iii) mentor highly motivated undergraduates in a teaching-intensive yet research-active environment. I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to the University of Richmond’s Robins School of Business and to join a community dedicated to teaching excellence, analytical impact, and student success.

I would be honored to join your faculty and to contribute to your teaching, research, and service missions. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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